

The truth about Reliance

Hi Niketu,
I read your article about the Reliance Internet connection. I must tell you that whenever I try to download, the connection gets disconnected. I believe it is because downloads absorb a lot of bandwidth, and this kind of a connection does not have a dedicated line. I tried to file a complaint with Reliance, but they too have no answer.

I have seen a lot of people give up their land-line connections and opt for Reliance, as it provides good connectivity. I think it is important that they know all the facts before they make their decision.

Vijyant Jain
Via e-mail



Hi Digit,

When I read the last issue, I was excited to read 'Rely on the Net'. I found that you mentioned the connection speed as 'varies between 40 Kbps to 80 Kbps'. From my experience with Reliance, the connection speed is about 115 Kbps—even when my handset has only two bars of signal strength (out of a maximum of six bars).

Pankaj Katiyar
Via e-mail

Dear Vijyant and Pankaj,

As you can see, our experiences were different, both better and worse. There are many factors that affect bandwidth—from signal strength, to the basic infrastructure network in your area. While Vijyant has poor connectivity, Pankaj is bumping up against the limits of the serial cable on his PC. With services, quality is unpredictable, and only Reliance can tell you what quality of service they assure.

digit

Ado about Editorial

Mr Hajela seems to be utterly disappointed with Microsoft, and has found a vent for his malice—the editorial. Just because you distributed a Linux DVD, Mr Hajela criticises, degrades and molests Microsoft, forgetting the umpteen Windows-based utilities and product distributions supplied with all your other issues.

He continues his cacophony saying that people don't update Windows because of lack of trust!! Do people trust Symantec, Message Labs and Trend Micro more? The only thing I ever ticked on a pop-up security box was 'Always trust content from Microsoft'.

Microsoft is like a religion for us, kindly don't molest it. If there superior products, state the facts and let people decide. If one can't respect the company that has played such a key role in the development and evolution of the Software industry, at least don't abuse it.

Rajat Garg
Via e-mail

Linux Costs

Dear Sumod,

This is in reference to your reply to Vicky Jambhore, in the Readers Letters section. SuSE is a Linux distribution, but I still have to pay in order to use it—even as a home user. There is so much buzz about Linux being free. If I have to buy an OS, then why not Windows 98 for under \$100 (Rs 4,600).

Microsoft offers Windows 95, NT, 98, 2000, XP, Server 2003, but on the other hand, Linux has SuSE, Redhat, Mandrake, Knoppix and host of other distributions—this is confusing. Linux distributors need to overcome this before challenging mighty Microsoft. How does Linux make money? Microsoft makes billions because it spends billions to make their operating systems.

Ashish Kumar Varun
Via e-mail

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Dear Ashish,

It is true that most Linux vendors now charge for their distributions, but like you pointed out, they too need to make money. Unfamiliarity is a big problem with Linux, so there are many vendors that specialise in making 'Windows replacement' distributions. We have tested some of these in our August Linux special, and you may want to try some of them out yourself. Of course, they are not free.

The whole point of Linux is the freedom of choice, and thus each vendor is free to add to and modify Linux as they choose. You can choose which one you would like to try. There still many free options, just not the big 'branded' ones. In the meanwhile, it is perfectly safe to install and try Red Hat 9 from our DVD, as long as you follow the guidelines carefully; and you have it for free!

Dear Rajat,

May all deserving companies get such loyalty, but when was the last time your anti-virus update needed an update to fix what it had updated? Microsoft security patches sometimes need additional patches to undo the damage. Look at the patch history for both Internet Explorer and Windows XP. System administrators are wary of any new patch, and we have talked to users who are reluctant to use Windows Update for fear of letting Microsoft 'scan' their computers. All facts.

We use Windows and Windows-based applications all over our offices, but that does not mean that they are flawless. With applied technology, it is a good idea to put religion aside and focus on practical benefits.

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Goof Ups

- The Liteon 52X/32X/5X costs Rs 2,750, and not Rs 2,995.
- The Samsung Digimax 201 has been referred to as the Digimax 210 in some places.
- The HP Inkjet printer costs Rs 2,999, and not Rs 550.
- On the cover, Internet has been misspelt as Intenet.

Notice any goof-ups?
Write to goof@jasubhai.com

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